

Interview Notes

Interviewee 1

Male

Year 1 student of China University of Mining and Technology

Quadruple room

Q: How do you clean your dorm every day?

A: We often collect our trash individually. There are some large trash bins placed near the lift in every floor of our dorm building, and we often throw the trash away every morning. The cleaners clear the trash bin every day.

Q: So are there some students who seldom clear their trash and let it just pill up in the dorm?

A: There aren't students like that. The students there are conscious, so they seldom let their trash pill up.

Interviewee 2

Female

Year 1 student of Guangxi Vocational College of Technology and Business

Six-person room

Q: How do you clean your dorm every day?

A: We often collect our trash before sleep and we take turns to throw it away.

Q: So are there some people who seldom throw away their trash and just let it pill up?

A: Few people do that. And if we encounter this kind of person, we will let him clear it up right away.

Q: Did you encounter frictions triggered by the trash problem?

A: It seems that there are some lazy people in other rooms, and some contradictions happened in these dorms. But I haven't seen that kind of people yet. Maybe it's lucky to come across my tidy roommates.

Interviewee 3

Male

Year 1 student of Fudan University,

Quadruple room (Three people)

Q: How do you clean your dorm every day?

A: We often throw away our trash every morning, and the cleaners clear the trash away every day. Plus, we take turns to mop the floor twice a week.

Q: So are there some students who seldom clear their trash and let it just pile up in the dorm?

A: Not really. And there are few people in my dorm. It's easy to communicate and manage ourselves.

Interviewee 4

Male

Year 1 student of Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Guangzhou)

Eight-person room with single bedroom

Q: How do you clean your dorm every day?

A: I merely throw away my personal trash when it's about to pile up. Some roommates like to eat takeaway in the living room and their rubbish piles up. But it's okay because they clean the living room every week.

Q: So do your roommates have some friction caused by the rubbish problem?

A: In my dorm, not really. Though there's rubbish piling up in the public area, it doesn't seem smelly and some roommates like to clean the dorm up actively. But in other dorm, that kind of thing truly happens. I heard from some upperclassmen that some students would bicker about the rubbish and thus they made some rules regarding that.

Q: Do you think that the rules may hurt the harmony in the dorm?

A: I think so.

Brief Conclusion:

Keeping the dorm space tidy relies highly on the residents' consciousness, but in some situations mandatory rules are established at a sacrifice of harmony. Also, most of the dorms lack an effective and convenient way for trash management and highly depends on the students to handle themselves.